Taher Samadi Shal

Senior Game Engineer • Unity (C#) • Unreal Engine 5 (C++) • Multiplayer • Cloud Backends

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SUMMARY

13 years making games in Unity and, since 2024, Unreal Engine 5. Shipped titles on Steam, mobile, and web, co-founded an award-winning studio, and led engineering on two Steam roguelikes, a cross-platform multiplayer TCG, and an unannounced AAA online game. Strongest in multiplayer, serverless backends, procedural systems, and developer tools.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Engines: Unity (C#, editor tooling) · Unreal Engine 5 (C++, Blueprints, replication, seamless travel)
Languages: C#, C++, JavaScript/Node.js, SQL, Python (working knowledge)
Multiplayer & Backend: Photon Fusion, PUN 2, Unreal Networking, AWS GameLift, Lambda, API Gateway, Cognito, DynamoDB, S3
Systems: Procedural generation, A* pathfinding & AI, physics/combat, save systems, quests/dialogue, in-app purchases, MVVM
Pipelines & Tools: Jenkins, TeamCity, GitHub CI, Git, SVN, Jira, Rider, Visual Studio, AI agents (Cursor, Claude, Antigravity)
Platforms: PC/Steam, macOS, iOS, Android, WebGL, PS4

EXPERIENCE

Senior Unity Engineer · DoubleCoconut, San Francisco, CA (Remote) — Jan 2026 – Present

- Architect and help maintain multiple mid-core Unity titles for client studios, and mentor their engineers.
- Optimize each title for its target platforms, using AI coding agents to speed up profiling and fixes.

Lead Unreal Programmer · Mars Games, Winter Park, FL — Dec 2024 – Nov 2025

- Architected the UE5 C++ online stack for an unannounced AAA game whose Gamescom 2025 build helped secure funding.
- Made gameplay server-authoritative on headless dedicated servers hosted on AWS GameLift, with seamless travel.
- Wrote player login and registration as serverless services on AWS Cognito, API Gateway, and Lambda.
- Designed cloud saves on DynamoDB and S3 that carry player and world data across servers and sessions.
- Replicated character data through PlayerState and synced procedural world events across clients.

Lead Unity Engineer · LiquidX, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia (Remote) — May 2023 – Sep 2024

- Owned the architecture of Warriors of Nova Thera, a roguelike based on the Pixelmon IP, through its Steam Closed Beta.
- Set up server-authoritative Photon Fusion multiplayer on a headless Unity server, keeping fast physics combat in sync.
- Created the hex-based procedural map generator and a spawn/reward system that scales difficulty and loot with progression.
- Directed the enemy AI and UI work, ran code reviews, and set up automated TeamCity builds.

Senior Unity Engineer · DoubleCoconut, San Francisco, CA (Remote) — Apr 2021 – Apr 2023

- Led Unity engineering on Emergents, a cross-platform multiplayer TCG, from concept to Open Beta.
- Built the rules engine on a Windows-hosted Photon PUN 2 relay server, keeping game logic off the client to stop cheating.
- Released Windows, macOS, Android, and WebGL builds together, tuned for mobile and browser performance.
- Worked out API contracts with five teams and kept weekly builds stable through Unity Cloud Build and GitHub CI.

Senior Unity Engineer · Badbadake Haft Aseman, Tehran, Iran — Oct 2018 – Mar 2021

- Led technical development of Naxia, an action-RPG roguelike, through its Steam release.
- Wrote the procedural dungeon generator with level-scaled enemy spawns and removed hitches from loading assets mid-run.
- Programmed branching quests and dialogue, an inventory, and saves that track character and world state.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Unity Developer · Pardazesh Negar Rashin, Tehran, Iran — Sep 2017 – Sep 2018

- Built the Photon PUN two-player mode for “Saychin” (rated 4.4/5 on Cafe Bazaar) and shipped several other mobile titles.

Co-Founder & Unity Developer · Midopia Game Studio, Iran — Apr 2013 – Oct 2017

- Designed and led programming on “Fractality” (Android), winner of the Golden Badge for Best Game of the Year at Iran's 10th Digital Media Festival. Pitched projects and secured external funding.

EDUCATION

M.S., Game Design (STEM) · Full Sail University · Valedictorian
M.S., Business Administration · Azad University
B.S., Industrial Management · University of Guilan

Authorized to work in the US (F-1 OPT); eligible for the 24-month STEM OPT extension.